Name: _____ Date: _____

HALLOWEEN

Where did Halloween come from?
A true story, and a little mystery.

Just Listen Learning • Halloween Special • Just listen, together.

1. Who or What Am I?

Write the word from the box that matches each clue.

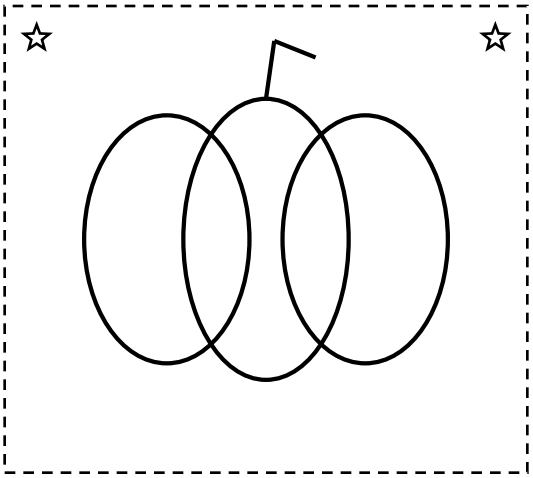
pumpkin	Samhain	guising	Stingy Jack
turnip	soul cakes	trick or treat	All Hallows' Eve

1. Old Irish festival at the end of summer
   _____
2. October 31, the evening before All Saints' Day
   _____
3. Small cakes given for prayers in old England
   _____
4. Dressing up and performing for treats
   _____
5. The root vegetable first carved into lanterns
   _____
6. Folktale man who lit his way with a coal
   _____
7. The big orange fruit Americans carve
   _____
8. Words kids say at the door (in print by the 1920s)
   _____

2. Poster Time!

Carve Your Own Lantern

Draw a friendly face on this pumpkin.
Then finish the sentence below.



I learned: _____

3. Then and Now: True or False?

Read each sentence. Write T if it is true or F if it is false.

____ 1. Historians know exactly how Samhain was celebrated long ago.

____ 2. "Hallow" is an old English word that means holy.

____ 3. Souling paid for treats with prayers for the dead.

____ 4. The first jack-o'-lanterns were carved from pumpkins.

____ 5. About a million Irish people came to America in the 1840s and 1850s.

____ 6. In World War Two, sugar rationing mostly paused trick-or-treating.

4. Think About It!

Answer in complete sentences.

1. Some websites say Samhain was a festival of the dead. Why is it smart to say "we don't know for sure"?

   _____

   _____

2. Name two things from the story that came together to make Halloween.

   _____

   _____

5. Timeline

Number the events 1 to 5, earliest first.

- ☐ Trick or treat in print
- ☐ Irish famine voyages
- ☐ All Souls' Day created
- ☐ Sugar rationing
- ☐ All Saints' Day on Nov 1

Halloween was built by many people, over many centuries.

Answer Key: Halloween

Just Listen Learning • Halloween Special • For parents and teachers

1. Who or What Am I?

1. Samhain
2. All Hallows' Eve
3. soul cakes
4. guising
5. turnip
6. Stingy Jack
7. pumpkin
8. trick or treat

2. Poster Time!

Drawings will vary. Look for a face drawn on the pumpkin and a true fact from the story in the sentence.

3. Then and Now: True or False?

1. F (the oldest writing comes from monks centuries later, and much is guesswork)
2. T
3. T
4. F (turnips came first; pumpkins came later in America)
5. T (many after the Great Famine)
6. T (in many places, for a few years)

4. Think About It!

1. Answers will vary. The oldest writing came from monks centuries later, so some ideas are guesses. Honest historians say what is known and what is not.
2. Any two: Samhain, All Hallows' Eve, soul cakes, guising, turnip lanterns, Stingy Jack, Irish and Scottish immigrants, pumpkins, trick-or-treating.

5. Timeline

1. All Saints' Day on Nov 1 (700s)
2. All Souls' Day created (998)
3. Irish famine voyages (1840s)
4. Trick or treat in print (1920s)
5. Sugar rationing (1940s)

Box numbers as printed, top to bottom: 4, 3, 2, 5, 1

All drawings on this worksheet are original line art. Facts come from the Just Listen episode "Halloween Didn't Start With Candy".